



# Delaware County Commissioners Meeting January 4th 2021

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=13fOh_kohRs">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=13fOh_kohRs</a> |
| Publication Date | 2021-01-04T17:57:16Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Summary

**Meeting Date:** January 4, 2021

**Prepared by:** Expert Civic Analyst

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** **00:00:11** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Commissioners meeting to order at 9:02 a.m. on Monday, January 4, 2021.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Commissioner Shannon Henry, Commissioner Sherry Riggan, and Commissioner James King.
  - **Absent:** None.
  - **Presiding Officer:** Initially conducted by outgoing or transitioning leadership; newly elected President James King assumed the gavel during the meeting.

### 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None explicitly recorded in this segment.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Not mentioned in this transcript segment.
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## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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### Reorganization of the Board of Commissioners

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:01:28 Election of Board Officers and Annual Appointments
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members and John (County Attorney / Staff)
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - The board conducted its annual reorganization.
  - Following discussion regarding scheduling rotations, Commissioner Sherry Riggan nominated Commissioner James King for President; seconded by Commissioner Riggan.
  - For Vice President, Commissioner King nominated Sherry Riggan; seconded by Commissioner Henry. Nominations were closed, and Riggan was confirmed as Vice President.
  - Staff presented the annual list of county appointments and department heads (including 911 Director Paul Singleton, Executive Administrator Jenny Hunnicutt, County Attorney John Brooke, EMA Director John Catino, EMS Director Mike Ashley, and others). A correction was made to the Airport Authority appointment, changing Ron Jones to Russell Jones.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
  - Election of James King as President: Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).
  - Closing Nominations for Vice President: Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).
  - Election of Sherry Riggan as Vice President: Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).
  - Approval of County Appointments (with corrections): Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).

### Emergency Declaration 2021-01

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:09:45 Emergency Declaration 2021-01 (COVID-19 Pandemic)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Staff / Commissioners
- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff presented an extension of the pandemic emergency declaration through the end of the month (aligning with the governor's extension and upcoming meetings). It maintains mask requirements for businesses and county buildings.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).

## Farm Ground Leases

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:10:50 Farm Ground Lease Agreements (Spangler Lease and Right & Light Lease)
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (County Staff)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff noted that bids were accepted at the December 21st meeting. Unsuccessful bidders on contested tracts opted not to increase bids, leaving the successful bidders in place. A minor typo under the Spangler lease (adjusting 30.02 acres to 30.2 acres) was corrected on record.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
  - Spangler Lease Agreement: Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).
  - Right & Light Lease Agreement: Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).

## Resolution 2021-001: Public Meeting Procedures

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:13:07 Resolution 2021-001: Establishing Policy Procedures to Protect Quorum and Foster Effective Administration of Public Meetings
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (County Staff)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff presented the standard annual resolution protecting meeting quorums and procedures (carried over from 2019). Commissioner Riggan recommended tabling the item to update it with modern electronic meeting formats (such as Facebook video broadcasting and updated public comment structures) rather than retaining outdated 3-minute limit language.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes). Will be updated for the next meeting.

## Resolution 2021-002: Rescinding Collective Bargaining

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:15:05 Resolution 2021-002: Rescinding Collective Bargaining for Employees
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Brooke (County Attorney)
- **Deliberation Summary:** Attorney Brooke explained that the county has one remaining collective bargaining agreement (with the United Auto Workers representing sheriff deputies, correctional officers, security bailiffs, and 911 employees) expiring in April 2021. Contract rules require a formal notice of termination between 60 and 120 days prior; adopting this resolution allows staff to issue the required notice.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).

## Payment of Claims

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:22:23 Payment of Claims
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Staff
- **Deliberation Summary:** Review and approval of county claims totaling \$4,031,507.14.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:22:48 **Staff Note on Public Comment:** County staff noted that a resident, Mr. Mansfield, was watching the proceedings via broadcast and requested a spelling correction for Mr. Walls' first name on the appointment documentation, which staff confirmed was completed. No other direct public spoken comments were recorded during this segment.

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - 00:16:58 Commissioner Henry and EMA Director John Catino commended county emergency personnel and the EMA team for their recent work over the weekend, including assisting the city with a successful search for a missing 10-year-old child utilizing the county's new drone technology (equipped with infrared/FLIR cameras) and providing support at local fires.
  - 00:19:16 EMA Director Catino provided an operational update regarding ongoing weekly coordination with the State Board of Health concerning COVID-19 vaccine distribution timelines (projected mid-January arrivals for public health testing sites) and upcoming public educational outreach campaigns utilizing grant funds.
- **Adjournment:** 00:23:09 The meeting recessed following a motion and a unanimous roll call vote (Henry: Yes, Riggan: Yes, King: Yes).